

Trees

All affected the same as last year

Horse Chestnuts

The leaves of all 8 of our Horse Chestnuts as well as a few saplings are looking very patchy and autumnal even though we're only just in July. Thanks to Ali for alerting us to the fact that it could be Horse Chestnut leaf blotch or leaf miner.



Horse chestnut leaf blotch is caused by a fungus and looks like irregular brown blotches with yellow margins.



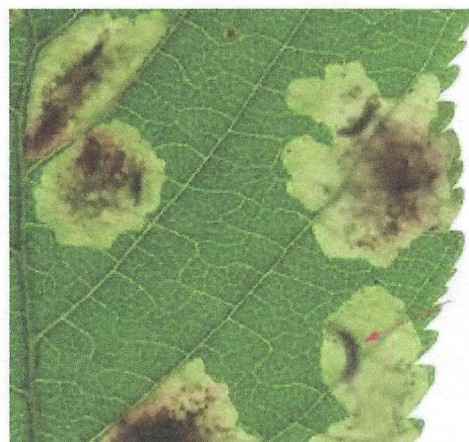
We think our blotchy leaves are caused by the leaf miner moth whose larvae mine within the leaves.



Hold a leaf up to the light and you might see the larvae, caterpillars or grubs whatever you like to call them mining and munching away inside the leaf.

Eventually the leaves die and drop off but new ones grow (and get infected).

They cause significant damage, as we can see, to the appearance of the trees but there is no evidence that the damage by the moth leads to tree death. However photosynthetic storage in the leaves may be reduced.



Treatment



Great and blue tits eat the larvae so encourage them? They only cope with a tiny percentage though.

Collecting fallen leaves and burning, or covering with soil to kill overwintering pupae.